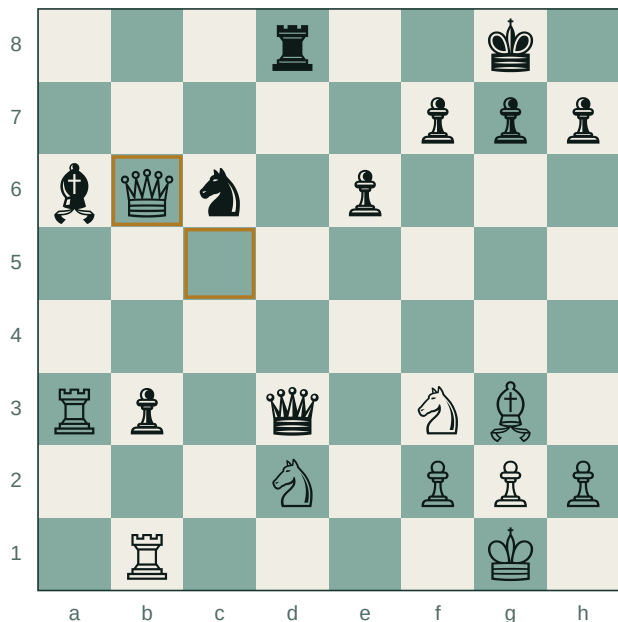


Clearance tactics: Black, move 25

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Qxb6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25...Qxb1+ 26. Nxb1 Rd1+ 27. Ne1 Rxe1#

25...Qxb1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on d8 attacks the knight on d2. Recorded reply: **26.Nxb1**.

26...Rd1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From d1 it attacks king on g1 and knight on b1. Recorded reply: **27.Ne1**.

27...Rxe1# Mate: rook on e1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on e1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on b6 and rook on a3. Check for tactical protection.